



Mindset & Well-being: Enlightened, Peaceful, Joyous, Renewed

*Overcoming anxious and toxic thoughts through biblical
principles
— a 4-week study for women*

For women of all ages

24 daily lessons · 120 study questions · 4 weekly essay prompts

All Scripture quotations are from the English Standard Version
(ESV)



WEEK 1

Enlightened

Welcome to Week 1

Welcome to Week 1 of your journey, friend — our theme this week is “Enlightened.” That is a beautiful word for what God wants to do in your mind: He wants to turn the light on. Anxious and toxic thoughts love the dark corners — the half-truths we whisper to ourselves at midnight, the lies we have believed for years. But light always wins over darkness, precious one. This week we will let God’s truth shine into every corner of our thinking: we will learn to name our thoughts, guard what goes in, reject the lies about who we are, trade worry for trust, set our minds on the Spirit, and speak truth out loud. You do not need a quiet house or an empty schedule — you can do this in the middle of laundry piles, school drop-offs, dinner prep, and sleepless nights. Each day, God has one small beam of truth for your heart. Let Him enlighten you, one day at a time.

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue lines, similar to standard notebook paper. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There is no handwriting or other markings on the paper.

Naming the Thoughts

“Worry is a cycle of inefficient thoughts whirling around a center of fear.”

— Corrie ten Boom

2 Corinthians 10:5

We destroy arguments and every lofty opinion raised against the knowledge of God, and take every thought captive to obey Christ,

Your mind is a busy place. Before you even get out of bed in the morning, thoughts are already racing: what to make for dinner, whether the bills will stretch, what that friend meant by her text, whether you are doing enough as a mom, a wife, a daughter, a friend. Some of those thoughts are true. But many of them are not. Some are anxious thoughts that steal your peace, and some are toxic thoughts that tear you down.

Today's verse gives us a picture of what to do with them. It says we can take every thought captive to obey Christ. Imagine a thought as a wild horse running loose in your head. You do not just let it run wild. You grab the reins. You bring it to Jesus and ask Him, "Is this thought true? Does it belong in my life?" Taking a thought captive is not the same as pretending you never had it. It means you catch it, you name it, and you hand it to Christ.

Here is the first step: start naming your thoughts today. When an anxious thought pops up while you are making lunch or driving

to work, pause and say to yourself, "That is a worry thought." When a mean thought about yourself shows up, say, "That is a lie I am telling myself." Once you name it, you have power over it. You can bring it to Jesus. You can say, "Lord, I will not let this thought run my day. I give it to You." That is how a captive thought bows down to Christ, and that is how your mind begins to be renewed.

Prayer

Lord Jesus, my mind runs so fast sometimes, especially in the morning rush when everyone needs something from me. Today I am asking You to slow me down and help me notice my thoughts. When an anxious thought comes, help me name it. When a toxic thought comes, help me catch it. I hand each one to You, Jesus, because I want my thoughts to obey You, not rule me. Give me a calm, clear mind today. Amen.

Questions

1. According to 2 Corinthians 10:5, what should we do with our thoughts?

- A. Let every thought run wild
- B. Pretend we never had the thought
- C. Take every thought captive to obey Christ
- D. Share every thought with a friend

2. What does "taking a thought captive" mean in this lesson?

- A. Catching a thought, naming it, and handing it to Jesus
- B. Locking the thought in a box
- C. Forgetting the thought completely
- D. Writing the thought down and hiding it

3. Which of these is an example of naming a thought the way the lesson teaches?

- A. Ignoring a worry and hoping it goes away
- B. Saying, "That is a worry thought," when anxiety pops up
- C. Keeping a worry secret so no one knows
- D. Letting a mean thought about yourself play on repeat

4. Why is naming a thought the first step?

- A. Because other people will respect you
- B. Because it makes the thought louder
- C. Because it proves you are a bad person
- D. Because once you name it, you have power over it and can bring it to Jesus

5. Which part of the verse shows that our thoughts should answer to Jesus?

- A. "Against the knowledge of God"
- B. "We destroy arguments"
- C. "To obey Christ"
- D. "Every lofty opinion"

My Notes

Guard What Goes In

“You cannot keep birds from flying over your head but you can keep them from building a nest in your hair.”

— Martin Luther

Proverbs 4:23

Keep your heart with all vigilance, for from it flow the springs of life.

Think about your kitchen sink. If you pour junk down the drain all day, the pipes clog up. Your heart and mind work the same way. Whatever you let into your eyes and ears ends up living in your thoughts. Today's verse says to keep your heart with all vigilance. That means guard it like a treasure, because everything in your life flows out of it.

Let us be honest about what flows into our minds each day. Scrolling through your phone late at night, comparing your home or your body to pictures online. Listening to gossip at school pickup or around the lunch table. Watching shows that plant dark or hopeless thoughts. These things do not just pass through. They stay. They become the voice inside your head that says you are not enough, or that everything is falling apart.

Martin Luther's picture helps here: you cannot stop every bad thought from flying over your head, but you do not have to let it build a nest there. Today, make one small change. Put the phone down before bed. Turn off a show that feeds your worry. Walk

away from a gossiping conversation. Guarding your heart is not about being perfect. It is about choosing what you let move in and live in your mind. Your heart is worth protecting.

Prayer

Father, I let so much junk flow into my mind without even noticing. The scrolling at night, the comparing, the shows and talk that leave me feeling worse. Tonight, help me put the phone down and guard my heart like You tell me to. Show me what to turn off and what to turn toward. Fill my mind with what is true and good instead. In Jesus' name, Amen.

Questions

1. According to Proverbs 4:23, why should we guard our hearts?

- A. Because hearts are fragile like glass
- B. Because other people want to steal our hearts
- C. Because guarding makes us popular
- D. Because from the heart flow the springs of life

2. What does Martin Luther's quote teach us?

- A. We can keep bad thoughts from settling down and living in our minds
- B. Birds are always bad
- C. Thoughts do not matter
- D. We can stop every bad thought from coming

3. Which of these is an example of guarding your heart?

- A. Scrolling your phone late into the night
- B. Joining in gossip at school pickup

- C. Turning off a show that feeds your worry and putting the phone down
- D. Watching anything you want without thinking about it

4. What happens when we let junk flow into our minds, according to the lesson?

- A. It just passes through and is gone
- B. It stays and becomes the voice inside our heads
- C. It makes us smarter
- D. Nothing happens at all

5. What does "vigilance" mean in this lesson?

- A. Watching over and guarding your heart carefully
- B. Worrying about everything
- C. Telling others what to do
- D. Being lazy and careless

My Notes

W E D N E S D A Y

The Lies We Believe About Ourselves

"God never withholds from His child that which His love and wisdom call good."

— Elisabeth Elliot

Psalm 139:13-14

For you formed my inward parts; you knitted me together in my mother's womb. I praise you, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Wonderful are your works; my soul knows it very well.

Every woman I know has heard lies in her own head about herself. "I am not pretty enough." "I am a bad mom." "I am too old to matter anymore." "Everyone else has it together and I do not." These thoughts feel so true that we rarely stop to ask where they came from. But they did not come from God. God's voice never tears you down. When a thought tells you that you are worthless, that is a lie, and you can take it captive.

Look at what today's verse says about you. God formed your inward parts. He knitted you together in your mother's womb. You are fearfully and wonderfully made. That means God put care and skill into making you, the same way an artist pours herself into a painting. You are His wonderful work. The mirror, the scale, the other moms at church, the pictures on your phone - none of them get to decide your worth. God already decided it.

Today, when a lie about yourself pops up, answer it out loud with the truth. "I feel like a failure, but God says I am fearfully and wonderfully made." You may feel silly at first, but the lie loses its power when you speak God's truth over it. You are not an accident. You are not too much and not not enough. You are exactly who God made on purpose.

Prayer

God, I stand in front of the mirror and all I see are the flaws. The lies come so easily: I am not enough, I am too old, I have messed up too much. Today I am choosing Your words over the lies. You formed me. You knitted me together. You call me wonderful. Help me believe what You say about me more than what the mirror or the world says. When a lie comes today, help me answer it with Your truth. Amen.

Questions

1. According to Psalm 139:13-14, who made you?

- A. You made yourself
- B. The world around you
- C. God formed your inward parts and knitted you together
- D. Nobody knows

2. What does "fearfully and wonderfully made" mean in this lesson?

- A. Made to be afraid
- B. Made exactly like everyone else
- C. Made by accident
- D. Made with God's care and skill, like an artist with a painting

3. When a lie about yourself pops up, what does the lesson say to do?

- A. Believe it because it feels true
- B. Answer it with God's truth from Scripture
- C. Keep it to yourself forever
- D. Let it play on repeat in your mind

4. Which of these is a lie that the lesson says does NOT come from God?

- A. "I am worthless and I don't matter"
- B. "God's works are wonderful"
- C. "God formed me with care"
- D. "I am fearfully and wonderfully made"

5. What does Elisabeth Elliot's quote remind us about God?

- A. God does not care about us
- B. God's wisdom is limited
- C. God withholds good things from His children
- D. God's love and wisdom always give His children what is truly good

My Notes

Worry vs. Trust

“Anxiety does not empty tomorrow of its sorrows, but only empties today of its strength.”

— Charles Spurgeon

Matthew 6:25-27

Therefore I tell you, do not be anxious about your life, what you will eat or what you will drink, nor about your body, what you will put on. Is not life more than food, and the body more than clothing? Look at the birds of the air: they neither sow nor reap nor gather into barns, and yet your heavenly Father feeds them. Are you not of more value than they? And which of you by being anxious can add a single hour to his span of life?

Worry is one of the most common thoughts women carry. You worry about money, about your kids' health and safety, about your aging parents, about the doctor's report, about what tomorrow will bring. Worry loves to visit at bedtime, when the house is finally quiet and your mind will not rest. Here is the hard truth Jesus teaches us: worry never fixes anything. It does not add a single hour to your life. It only drains the strength you need for today.

Jesus points us to the birds. They do not plant crops or stock up barns, and yet your heavenly Father feeds them every single day. Then Jesus asks the most loving question: are you not of more value than they? If God takes care of birds, how much

more will He take care of you, His daughter? Worry says, "I have to figure this out alone." Trust says, "My Father sees me and He will provide."

Today, practice trading worry for trust. When a worry thought comes, name it: "That is a worry thought." Then turn it into a prayer: "Lord, I am worried about the bills. I trust You to take care of us." You may have to do this ten times today. That is fine. Every time you hand a worry to God instead of carrying it yourself, your faith grows a little stronger and your heart gets a little lighter.

Prayer

Heavenly Father, it is late and the house is quiet, but my mind will not stop. I am worried about the money, the kids, the future - so many things I cannot control. Jesus, You said worrying adds nothing to my life. So I am handing You my worries one by one tonight. You feed the birds; I know You will take care of me. Help me trust You instead of tossing and turning. Give me Your peace as I sleep. Amen.

Questions

1. According to Matthew 6:27, what can worry add to your life?

- A. Extra money in the bank
- B. Nothing - not a single hour
- C. Better health
- D. A single hour to your span of life

2. What example does Jesus use to show God's care?

- A. The trees in the forest
- B. The stars in the sky

- C. The fish in the sea
- D. The birds of the air that God feeds

3. What is the difference between worry and trust in this lesson?

- A. Worry says "I have to figure this out alone"; trust says "My Father sees me and He will provide"
- B. They are exactly the same thing
- C. Worry is good and trust is bad
- D. Trust means you never think about problems

4. According to Corrie ten Boom's quote, what does worry do?

- A. It gives us more energy
- B. It empties tomorrow of its sorrow
- C. It empties today of its strength
- D. It solves all our problems

5. What should you do when a worry thought comes, according to the lesson?

- A. Name it and turn it into a prayer, handing it to God
- B. Pretend it does not exist
- C. Stay awake all night thinking about it
- D. Carry it all by yourself

My Notes

FRIDAY

Setting Your Mind on the Spirit

"God permits what He hates, to accomplish that which He loves."

— Joni Eareckson Tada

Romans 8:6

For to set the mind on the flesh is death, but to set the mind on the Spirit is life and peace.

Your mind is like a garden. Whatever you keep thinking about is what grows. Today's verse says that setting your mind on the flesh - on fear, on bitterness, on comparing, on the worst-case story - leads to death. Not a quick death, but the slow dying of joy and peace. But setting your mind on the Spirit leads to life and peace. The same mind, pointed in a different direction, grows completely different fruit.

Setting your mind on the Spirit is a daily choice, made in small moments. You are standing in a long line at the store and your mind starts spinning about everything going wrong. You can let it spin, or you can set your mind: "Lord, You are with me right now." Your teenager says something sharp and your mind wants to replay it all evening. You can let it replay, or you can set your mind: "God, help me respond with love." This is not pretending problems do not exist. It is choosing where your thoughts will live.

Joni Eareckson Tada knows about choosing where the mind lives. After a diving accident left her unable to move, she could have set her mind on bitterness. Instead she set it on God's goodness, and found that God can use even hard things to grow something He loves. This week you have learned to name your thoughts, guard your heart, reject the lies, and trade worry for trust. Today, make it a habit: set your mind on the Spirit, and watch life and peace grow.

Prayer

Holy Spirit, I am standing in this long line and my mind wants to spin about everything that is wrong. Right now I choose to set my mind on You. You are with me in this ordinary moment. When my thoughts drift toward fear or bitterness today, pull them back to You. Grow life and peace in my mind the way You grow a garden. I want my thoughts to live where You live. Amen.

Questions

1. According to Romans 8:6, what happens when we set our minds on the Spirit?

- A. We get life and peace
- B. We get death
- C. Nothing happens
- D. We become perfect

2. What does "setting your mind on the flesh" lead to, according to the verse?

- A. Strength
- B. Life and peace

- C. Death
- D. Joy

3. Which of these is an example of setting your mind on the Spirit?

- A. Replaying a hurtful comment all evening
- B. Praying, "Lord, You are with me right now," in a long line at the store
- C. Spinning about everything going wrong
- D. Comparing yourself to others on your phone

4. What is the garden picture in the lesson teaching?

- A. That plants need water
- B. That you should only think about flowers
- C. That gardening is a good hobby
- D. That whatever you keep thinking about is what grows in your mind

5. What did Joni Eareckson Tada choose after her accident, according to the lesson?

- A. To set her mind on God's goodness and trust His purpose
- B. To never think about it again
- C. To set her mind on bitterness
- D. To stop believing in God

Friday Essay

This week you learned to name your thoughts, guard your heart, reject the lies about yourself, trade worry for trust, and set your mind on the Spirit. Think about one anxious or toxic thought that visits you again and again. Write about it: what is the thought, where do you think it came from, and how would you use this week's lessons to take it captive and set your mind on the Spirit instead? Be honest and specific.

My Essay

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Speaking Truth Out Loud

"Kind words can be short and easy to speak, but their echoes are truly endless."

— Mother Teresa

Proverbs 18:21

Death and life are in the power of the tongue, and those who love it will eat its fruits.

All week we have been working on the thoughts inside our heads. Today we turn to the words that come out of our mouths. Today's verse says that death and life are in the power of the tongue. Your words carry weight. They can tear down or build up - not just other people, but yourself. The things you say out loud shape the way you think and the way your family feels.

Listen to yourself for one day. How often do you say, "I can't do this," "I'm so stupid," "Nothing ever goes right for me"? Those words are planting death in your own heart. Now imagine replacing them with life: "This is hard, but God is with me." "I made a mistake, and I can try again." "God is taking care of us." Speaking truth out loud is one of the strongest ways to take a thought captive. When the lie is spoken, answer it with spoken truth.

Your words also feed the people you love. The kind word you speak to your child before school, the encouragement you give your husband, the blessing you speak over a tired friend - their

echoes are truly endless, just like Mother Teresa said. A child remembers the words of her mother for the rest of her life. Today, speak life. Say one true, kind, brave thing out loud - to yourself, to your family, to a friend. Let your tongue be a tool of life, not death.

Prayer

Lord, my words have not always been life-giving. I have spoken harsh things about myself and about the people I love, and I am sorry. Today I want my tongue to speak life. Help me catch the death words before they leave my mouth. Put kind, true, brave words on my lips instead. Let my children and my family hear life from me today. Use my voice to bless, not to break. In Jesus' name, Amen.

Questions

1. According to Proverbs 18:21, what is in the power of the tongue?

- A. Nothing at all
- B. Only jokes
- C. Only silence
- D. Death and life

2. Which of these is an example of speaking "death" words about yourself?

- A. "This is hard, but God is with me"
- B. "I made a mistake, and I can try again"
- C. "I'm so stupid, nothing ever goes right for me"
- D. "God is taking care of us"

3. According to the lesson, why is speaking truth out loud powerful?

- A. Because spoken truth is one of the strongest ways to take a thought captive
- B. Because other people will be impressed
- C. Because it keeps you from ever being wrong
- D. Because it makes you the loudest person in the room

4. What does Mother Teresa's quote teach us about kind words?

- A. Kind words are long and hard to say
- B. Kind words have endless echoes - they keep working long after we speak them
- C. Kind words do not matter
- D. Only famous people can speak kind words

5. How can your words affect your family, according to the lesson?

- A. Only children notice your words
- B. They have no effect on anyone
- C. They can tear down or build up the people you love
- D. Only actions matter, never words

My Notes

A Week of Being Intentional

Take a slow breath, friend. You made it through Week 1. Now look back at the week with a thankful heart. Think about all the times you paused this week - while making lunch, driving to work, standing in line, lying in bed - and chose what to let into your mind on purpose. That is what it means to be intentional. You did not let every thought run wild. You did not let every worry have the last word. You guarded your heart, you answered lies with truth, you traded worry for trust, and you spoke life out loud.

None of this was about being perfect. It was about paying attention. Every time you noticed a thought and brought it to Jesus, you were taking it captive. Every time you put the phone down or turned away from gossip, you were guarding your heart. Every time you spoke a kind word instead of a harsh one, you were choosing life. God sees all of it, and He is so pleased.

Thank Him today. Thank Him for a mind that is being renewed, one small choice at a time. Thank Him for showing you that your thoughts do not have to run your life - He does. Rest in His peace this Sunday. You have been intentional this week, and that is a beautiful offering to the God who made you fearfully and wonderfully. Next week, we will go even deeper.

My Notes

Looking Back — Week 1

This week we walked in the light, and what a difference light makes. On Monday we learned to name our thoughts and take them captive to obey Christ — the first beam of light. On Tuesday we learned to guard our hearts with vigilance, choosing what we let into our minds. On Wednesday we shone truth on the lies we believe about ourselves, remembering that God fearfully and wonderfully made us. On Thursday we traded worry for trust, learning that worry adds nothing while our Father cares for us like the birds of the air. On Friday we practiced setting our minds on the Spirit, which brings life and peace. And on Saturday we discovered the power of speaking truth out loud, because death and life are in the power of the tongue. An enlightened mind is simply a mind where God’s light has been turned on. Keep letting His light in, friend. You are being renewed.

My Notes





WEEK 2

Peaceful

Welcome to Week 2

Welcome to Week 2, precious one — our theme is “Peaceful.” Last week God turned the light on in our minds; this week He quiets our hearts. Peaceful is what your heart was made for. Not the fragile quiet that shatters the moment the phone rings, but the deep, steady peace of a woman who knows she is held. This week we will learn the beautiful trade: we lay our worries gently at God’s feet in prayer, and He fills our hearts with His peace in return. You will learn how to bring everything to God, how His peace stands guard over your heart, how to throw your cares onto Him, how your Father already knows what you need, how thanksgiving pushes worry right out of your heart, and how His tender comforts cheer a many-cared soul. One day at a time, dear one. One sweet prayer at a time.

MONDAY

Bring It All to Him

“Any concern too small to be turned into a prayer is too small to be made into a burden.”

— Corrie ten Boom

Philippians 4:6

do not be anxious about anything, but in everything by prayer and supplication with thanksgiving let your requests be made known to God.

Dear one, have you ever lain awake at night with your mind running in circles? Maybe it is the bills on the kitchen counter, or a text from your daughter that sounded a little off, or the ache in your back that makes you wonder if something is wrong. Sweet friend, worry is a thief. It steals your sleep, it steals the joy in your morning coffee, and it steals the peace of the beautiful day God gave you. Corrie ten Boom lived through a prison camp during the war, and she learned this the hard way: any concern too small to be turned into a prayer is too small to be made into a burden. So instead of carrying those little worries around all day, turn them into prayers.

But Paul gives us such a tender habit in Philippians 4:6. He does not say, never feel anything, precious one. He says, do not stay stuck in anxiety about anything. Instead, in everything, pray. Prayer is simply talking to God, like you would talk to your dearest friend. Supplication is just the Bible word for asking with your whole heart. Nothing is too small for Him, and

nothing is too big. The late-night fear about your teenager, the grocery money, the doctor appointment on Thursday. Bring it all, lovely one. Your Father is never too busy for your list.

And notice the thanksgiving part, sweet friend. Before you even get an answer, you thank Him. Thank Him for listening. Thank Him for the home He gave you, for the breath in your lungs, for the child asleep down the hall. Thanksgiving turns your prayer from a panic into a trust. So tonight, when the worries start to pile up, try this: instead of scrolling your phone for an hour, open your hands and tell God every single thing. Trade the worry for a sweet conversation with your Father. He is listening, and He loves you so.

Prayer

Dear Lord, it is late and the house is quiet, and my mind is loud. You know my list, sweet Father: the money, the kids, the fear I do not even want to say out loud. Right now I lay each one gently at Your feet. Thank You for hearing me. Thank You for loving me. Thank You that I do not have to carry these alone. Wrap me in Your arms tonight and help me rest. In Jesus' precious name, Amen.

Questions

1. According to Philippians 4:6, what should we do instead of staying anxious?

- A. Think harder until we solve the problem ourselves
- B. Worry only about the small things
- C. Bring everything to God in prayer with thanksgiving
- D. Wait until we feel calm before we pray

2. What does Corrie ten Boom say worry does?

- A. It empties today of its strength
- B. It makes tomorrow easier to face
- C. It shows that we care about others
- D. It helps us plan better

3. In plain words, what does the Bible word supplication mean?

- A. Singing worship songs
- B. Praying only with other people
- C. Staying silent before God
- D. Asking God with your whole heart

4. Why does the lesson say to add thanksgiving to our prayers?

- A. It makes God love us more
- B. It turns our prayer from panic into trust
- C. It makes our prayers shorter
- D. It is only needed on Sundays

5. Which of these is a good way to practice this verse tonight?

- A. Scroll the phone until you fall asleep
- B. Hide your worries from God
- C. Tell God every worry instead of carrying it alone
- D. Wait for the worry to go away on its own

My Notes

A Peace That Stands Guard

“Thou hast made us for thyself, O Lord, and our heart is restless until it finds its rest in thee.”

— Augustine of Hippo

Philippians 4:7

And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus.

Yesterday we learned to bring everything to God in prayer, sweet friend. Today we learn what He gives back: His peace. And oh, look at what kind of peace it is. Paul says it surpasses all understanding. That means it does not have to make sense, dear one. Your bills may not be paid yet. Your child may still be struggling. The doctor may not have called back. And still, right in the middle of it all, God can pour a peace into your heart that your mind cannot explain. A peace that does not match the situation is how you know it came from heaven.

Look at the lovely picture Paul paints. This peace will guard your hearts and your minds. A guard stands watch at a door so nothing harmful gets in. When worry knocks on your heart, precious one, God's peace stands there like a faithful guard and says, you cannot come in here. It guards your mind too, that tender place where the worst what-ifs love to live. Prayer opens the door, and peace moves in and stands watch.

Augustine knew this long before you and I did. He wrote that God made us for Himself, and our hearts stay restless until they rest in Him. That restless feeling you get at night, dear one, the toss and turn, the scrolling, the replaying of conversations in your head, that is your beautiful heart looking for its rest. Your heart will never find it in a quieter house, a bigger paycheck, or a perfect family. It finds it in Him. Bring the worry to Him in prayer, and His peace will guard what worry used to rob.

Prayer

Father, the kids are finally asleep down the hall and the house is still, but my heart is not. Tonight I am asking for the peace that does not make sense, the sweet peace only You can give. Stand guard at the door of my heart and my mind, Lord. Do not let the worries in. I was made for You, and I long to rest in You. Thank You for being my safe place, my gentle shelter. In Jesus' precious name, Amen.

Questions

- 1. According to Philippians 4:7, what will God's peace do?**
 - A. Make all our problems disappear
 - B. Guard your hearts and your minds
 - C. Come only when life is easy
 - D. Work only for pastors and leaders
- 2. What does the lesson say surpasses all understanding means?**
 - A. It is too complicated to explain to anyone
 - B. It is only for church leaders
 - C. It only comes on Sundays
 - D. It is a peace that does not have to make sense of everything

3. Augustine says our heart stays restless until what?

- A. It finds its rest in God
- B. We get enough sleep
- C. All our plans work out
- D. We stop working so hard

4. The lesson compares God's peace to what?

- A. A warm blanket on a cold night
- B. A quiet house after the kids leave
- C. A guard standing watch at the door of your heart and mind
- D. A calendar with nothing on it

5. When is a good time to ask God for this peace?

- A. Only on Sunday mornings
- B. Anytime worry starts knocking at your heart
- C. After every problem is solved
- D. When you finally feel strong enough

My Notes



Let Him Carry It

“Never be afraid to trust an unknown future to a known God.”

— Corrie ten Boom

1 Peter 5:7

casting all your anxieties on him, because he cares for you.

The word Peter uses here is casting, and it is such a strong, freeing word, dear one. It does not mean placing your worries down gently. It means throwing them, the way you would toss a heavy basket of laundry right off your shoulders. God does not want you to hand Him one small worry and keep carrying the rest, sweet friend. He says cast ALL your anxieties. Every single one. The aging parent you are caring for, the teenager who will not talk to you, the job that wears you out, the marriage that feels heavy. All of it. Throw it into His strong, loving arms.

And here is the reason He gives, precious one: because he cares for you. Not because He is far away and unmoved. Not because your worry is a bother to Him. He cares for you personally, the way a tender father watches his daughter and cannot bear to see her struggle under a load she was never meant to carry. You would never watch your little one try to carry a heavy box across the house alone. How much more does your heavenly Father long to lift what is crushing you?

Corrie ten Boom survived things most of us will never face, and she came out of it saying this: never be afraid to trust an

unknown future to a known God. You do not know what tomorrow holds, sweet friend. That is true. But you know who holds it. You know His heart. You know He cares for you. So today, when a worry shows up, picture yourself picking it up with both hands and throwing it into the arms of God. Then leave it there, dear one. It is His to carry now, not yours.

Prayer

Lord, my hands are tired from gripping the steering wheel of my life. I keep trying to carry it all, sweet Father: my mother, my children, my work, my fears about what comes next. Right now I am throwing it all into Your arms. I trust the unknown future to You because I know You, and I know You care for me so tenderly. Hold what I cannot hold. In Jesus' precious name, Amen.

Questions

1. What does the word casting mean in this verse?

- A. Hiding your worries where no one can see
- B. Quietly thinking them through alone
- C. Writing them in a journal and forgetting them
- D. Throwing all your anxieties onto God like a heavy load

2. Why can we cast our cares on God?

- A. Because God is too busy for small things
- B. Because he cares for you
- C. Because our worries make God stronger
- D. Because worrying impresses God

3. The lesson compares casting your cares to what?

- A. Folding laundry neatly
- B. Carrying a basket upstairs alone
- C. Tossing a heavy basket of laundry off your shoulders and into God's hands
- D. Sorting clothes by color

4. Corrie ten Boom says never be afraid to trust what?

- A. An unknown future to a known God
- B. Your own careful plans
- C. Everyone else's advice
- D. A perfectly clean and quiet house

5. Which worry is too small to cast on God?

- A. The big medical bill
- B. Your teenager's attitude
- C. Your tired heart at the end of the day
- D. None of them, He wants them all

My Notes

Your Father Already Knows

“Pray, and let God worry.”

— Martin Luther

Matthew 6:31-33

Therefore do not be anxious, saying, 'What shall we eat?' or 'What shall we drink?' or 'What shall we wear?' For the Gentiles seek after all these things, and your heavenly Father knows that you need them all. But seek first the kingdom of God and his righteousness, and all these things will be added to you.

Listen to the worry list Jesus gives, dear one: what shall we eat, what shall we drink, what shall we wear. Does that sound familiar, sweet friend? It is the grocery list, the kids' shoes that cost more than you planned, the rent, the gas money. Jesus is not talking about imaginary problems. He is talking about the real needs of real women in real kitchens. And He looks at you with such love and says: do not be anxious about these things.

Here is why, precious one. Your heavenly Father knows that you need them all. Read that again slowly, and let it settle into your heart. He already knows. Before you worried about it, before you made the list, before you lay awake adding it all up, your Father in heaven knew. The people who do not know God spend their whole lives chasing these things, running hard, afraid they will run out. But you are not running alone, sweet friend. You have a Father who knows your needs and delights to meet them.

So what do we do instead of worrying? Jesus says: seek first the kingdom of God and his righteousness, and all these things will be added to you. Seeking His kingdom first simply means putting God first in your day and your choices, dear one: a morning prayer before the phone, honesty when it would be easier to cut corners, kindness when you are tired, trust when you want to panic. Put Him first, and He handles the adding. That is why Martin Luther, who was a worrier himself, gave the simplest, sweetest advice: pray, and let God worry. You do your part, lovely one. He will do His.

Prayer

Father, I am standing in my kitchen planning the meals and the budget, and the numbers feel tight. Thank You that You already know what I need before I even ask, sweet Father. Help me put You first today, in the little choices and the big ones. I will do my part and trust You with the rest. Thank You for being a Father who provides so faithfully. In Jesus' precious name, Amen.

Questions

1. What three needs does Jesus list that people worry about?

- A. What we eat, what we drink, what we wear
- B. Money, fame, and success
- C. Work, school, and church
- D. Health, weather, and travel

2. Who already knows what you need?

- A. Your best friend
- B. Your neighbors

- C. Your heavenly Father
- D. Only you

3. What does Jesus tell us to seek first?

- A. A better job
- B. The kingdom of God and His righteousness
- C. An easier life
- D. Everyone's approval

4. What was Martin Luther's simple advice about worry?

- A. Worry a little every day so you stay ready
- B. Ask everyone else to fix it for you
- C. Do it all without prayer
- D. Pray, and let God worry

5. What happens when we seek God's kingdom first?

- A. All our troubles disappear forever
- B. We never have to work again
- C. All these things will be added to us
- D. Life becomes boring

My Notes

Thanksgiving Fights Worry

“Prayer without ceasing is only possible in a life of continual thanks. How did I ever think there was another way to enter into His courts but with thanksgiving?”

— Ann Voskamp

Colossians 4:2

Continue steadfastly in prayer, being watchful in it with thanksgiving.

Paul gives three tender words about prayer in this one short verse, dear one, and they are worth holding close. Continue. Stay watchful. With thanksgiving. Continue steadfastly simply means keep at it and do not quit, sweet friend. Do not pray once and walk away. Keep talking to God like you would keep talking to your dearest friend. Stay watchful means stay awake to what He is doing, noticing His gentle hand in your day instead of sleeping through your blessings. And then the weapon, precious one: with thanksgiving.

Thanksgiving is a weapon against anxiety. Think about it, sweet friend. Worry fills your mind with what might go wrong. Thanksgiving fills your mind with what God has already done right. The two cannot both rule your beautiful heart at the same time. When you start listing His gifts, the worry starts to shrink. Ann Voskamp, a mother who learned this in the middle of real grief, wrote a whole book counting one thousand gifts. She discovered that giving thanks is the doorway into God's

presence, and that constant thanks makes constant prayer possible.

And here is the part that should stop us in our tracks, dear one: Paul wrote these words from prison. He was locked up, and he was telling other people to keep praying with thanksgiving. If he could give thanks in a cell, we can give thanks in our kitchen. So start small today, lovely one. The warm coffee in your hand. The sunrise through the kitchen window. Your child's laugh from the next room. The roof over your head. Say them out loud. Write them down. Every thank-you is a swing of the sword against worry.

Prayer

Lord, the house is still asleep and my coffee is warm, and I want to start this day with thanks instead of worry. Thank You for this sweet morning. Thank You for my family. Thank You for the roof over us and the food in the fridge. Thank You that You walk beside me today. Help me keep thanking You all day long, and let my thanks push every worry right out of my heart. In Jesus' precious name, Amen.

Questions

1. What three things does Colossians 4:2 tell us to do in prayer?

- A. Stop, sit, and sigh
- B. Give up, get quiet, and go to sleep
- C. Continue, stay watchful, and give thanks
- D. Hurry, worry, and hide

2. In plain words, what does continue steadfastly mean?

- A. Pray once and hope for the best

- B. Pray only when you feel like it
- C. Pray fast so it is over quickly
- D. Keep praying and do not quit

3. Ann Voskamp says continual prayer is only possible in what kind of life?

- A. A life of continual thanks
- B. A life with no problems
- C. A life of perfect quiet
- D. A life spent at church

4. Why is thanksgiving called a weapon against anxiety in this lesson?

- A. Because it is louder than worry
- B. Because gratitude pushes worry out and fills the heart with trust
- C. Because God commands it on Fridays
- D. Because it takes a very long time

5. Where was Paul when he wrote the letter to the Colossians?

- A. On a quiet farm in the country
- B. At a happy wedding feast
- C. On a long and pleasant journey
- D. In prison

Friday Essay

This week you have been learning to trade worry for prayer. Think of one worry you keep carrying. Write about it honestly: what is it, when does it hit you hardest, and what would it look like to meet it with prayer and thanksgiving instead? Name one small thing you will thank God for this week every time that worry rises, and describe when and where you will pray about it.

My Essay

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal purple lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins or other markings on the paper.

Cheered by His Comfort

“The beginning of anxiety is the end of faith, and the beginning of true faith is the end of anxiety.”

— George Müller

Psalm 94:19

When the cares of my heart are many, your consolations cheer my soul.

Sweet friend, hear how honest David is in this verse. He does not pretend he has it all together. When the cares of my heart are many, he says. Many. Not one small worry, but a whole pile of them. If that is you today, dear one, you are in good company. It is Saturday, and maybe the laundry is still waiting, and the errands never got done, and the week left you tired in a way that sleep does not seem to fix. David would understand. He has been there.

But notice what David does next. He does not stay in the pile of cares. He turns to God, and he finds that God's consolations cheer his soul. Consolations is simply a lovely word for God's comforts, the gentle ways He lifts a heavy heart. It might be a verse that finds you at just the right moment. It might be a friend's text that says, I am thinking of you. It might be the quiet feeling, deep inside, that you are not alone in this. God's comfort does not always change the situation, but it always changes the weight of it.

And here is what George Muller, a man who cared for thousands of orphans on prayer alone, wanted us to know: where faith begins, anxiety ends. They cannot both sit on the throne of your heart at once. The cheer God gives is not a painted-on smile for other people to see. It is a real lift in your soul, the kind that lets you breathe a little deeper and stand a little taller. So today, precious one, let Him cheer you. Tell Him your many cares, and then make room for His comfort. He is so very tender with tired hearts.

Prayer

Dearest Lord, it is Saturday evening and the week is winding down. My heart is carrying so many cares, and I am tired, Lord, truly tired. I bring them all to You now, every last one. And I ask for Your comfort, the sweet consolations that only You can give. Cheer my soul, Father. Lift this heaviness. Let me feel how tenderly You hold me. I love You, and I trust You. In Jesus' name, Amen.

Questions

1. What does the psalm say happens when the cares of our heart are many?

- A. We should hide them from God
- B. God's comforts cheer our soul
- C. We should worry even more
- D. We should stay busy until they pass

2. What does George Müller's quote teach us?

- A. Faith and anxiety cannot both lead the heart at once
- B. Worry is a form of worship

- C. Anxiety is the same thing as faith
- D. Faith makes anxiety stronger

3. The lesson says God's consolations are what?

- A. Strict rules to obey
- B. Loud voices to ignore
- C. Busy work to fill our day
- D. His comforts that cheer and lift our soul

4. Which is a many cares example from the lesson?

- A. A quiet Sunday nap
- B. A good night's sleep
- C. Saturday's pile of laundry, errands, and family needs
- D. An empty calendar

5. What is the true cheer that God gives?

- A. A real lift in the soul, not a fake smile
- B. Pretending everything is fine
- C. Smiling in every photo
- D. Never crying again

My Notes

A Week of Turning Worry Into Prayer

Precious one, take a quiet moment today and look back at this week with a thankful heart. On Monday you learned to bring everything to God. On Tuesday you met the peace that stands guard over your heart and mind. On Wednesday you threw your cares onto Him. On Thursday you rested in knowing your Father already knows what you need. On Friday you picked up thanksgiving as your weapon against worry. And yesterday you let His comfort cheer your tired soul.

This week you were intentional, and that matters. Being intentional simply means you chose, on purpose, to turn your worries into prayers instead of letting them run wild. Maybe it felt awkward at first. Maybe some nights the worry still came. That is alright, dear one. A new habit grows a little stronger each day, like a seed pushing up through the soil. God saw every prayer you whispered, every thanks you counted, every care you cast on Him.

Today, just be grateful. Thank Him for walking with you this week. Thank Him for the peace you felt, even for a moment. And carry this gentle habit into next week: when worry knocks, open the door to prayer instead. You are so loved, and you are never, ever alone in it.

My Notes

Looking Back — Week 2

What a peaceful week it has been, dear friend. We began by learning to bring everything to God in prayer, holding nothing back and adding thanksgiving even before the answer comes. Then we discovered the peace of God that stands guard over our hearts and minds, a peace too deep for our minds to explain. We learned to cast, to truly throw, all our anxieties onto Him because He cares for us so personally. We rested in the sweet truth that our heavenly Father already knows what we need, so we can seek Him first and let Him handle the rest. We picked up thanksgiving as a weapon, letting gratitude push worry out of our hearts. And we ended with David’s honest cry, letting God’s tender comforts cheer our many-cared souls. The thread through it all is this: worry was never yours to carry, prayer was always the way, and His peace is always the promise. Stay peaceful, lovely one. He is faithful, and He is holding you.

My Notes





WEEK 3

Joyous

Welcome to Week 3

Welcome to Week 3, daughter — our theme is “Joyous.” A renewed mind is not a grim, serious mind. It is a joyful one. Joy is what happens when truth moves from your head to your heart — when you stop merely surviving your thoughts and start delighting in God’s. This week we will let His truth reshape our thinking and watch joy bubble up: God transforming the way you think, aiming your thoughts upward, drinking from His Word day and night, trading fear for His power, choosing what you think about, and feeding your mind its daily bread. You do not have to do this perfectly. Just show up, let Him do the shaping, and let joy surprise you.

Let God Change the Way You Think

“What comes into our minds when we think about God is the most important thing about us.”

— A. W. Tozer

Romans 12:2

Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewal of your mind, that by testing you may discern what is the will of God, what is good and acceptable and perfect.

God does not ask you to just try harder. He offers to change you from the inside out. The verse says do not let the world pour you into its mold. The world has a mold for you: hurry, worry, compare, and control. God has something better. He wants to transform you by renewing your mind. That word transformed is the same word used when a plain caterpillar becomes a butterfly. That is not the caterpillar trying harder. It is God doing something brand new.

Think about an ordinary day. You wake up and reach for your phone. Before your feet even hit the floor, headlines and other people's perfect-looking lives are filling your mind. At work you replay a sharp comment a coworker made. At bedtime you rehearse tomorrow's problems. Our minds are always being shaped by something. Paul is saying: let it be God who shapes yours.

A. W. Tozer said it simply: what comes into our minds when we think about God is the most important thing about us. If your picture of God is small, your worries will be big. If you believe He is good, loving, and near, your mind has somewhere safe to land. That is why renewing your mind is not a one-time event. It is daily, like washing dishes. You eat off plates every day, so you wash them every day. You think thoughts every day, so you bring them to God every day.

Here is a simple practice for this week. When a thought grabs you, pause and ask one small question: Is this how the world thinks, or is this how God thinks? The world says you must earn love. God says you are loved already. The world says panic. God says peace. Each time you choose His way of thinking, your mind is renewed a little more. That is transformation, one thought at a time.

Prayer

Father, here I am at the start of a busy week, and my mind is already full. Before the laundry piles up, before the messages come in, before the worries start their noise, I give You my thoughts. Show me where the world has been doing my thinking for me. Remind me who You are — good, kind, and close. Change me the way a caterpillar becomes a butterfly: not by my effort, but by Your work in me. When a heavy thought comes today, help me ask: is this how You think? Renew my mind, Lord. In Jesus' name, amen.

Questions

1. According to Romans 12:2, what does God use to transform us?

- A. Our hard work and good behavior
- B. The renewal of our minds
- C. Trying to copy what others do
- D. Avoiding all difficult people

2. In the lesson, what picture is used to explain the word 'transformed'?

- A. A seed growing into a flower
- B. A house being repainted
- C. A wave rolling onto the shore
- D. A caterpillar becoming a butterfly

3. What did A. W. Tozer say is the most important thing about us?

- A. What comes into our minds when we think about God
- B. How many Bible verses we have memorized
- C. How early we wake up to pray
- D. How much we do for our church

4. What simple question does the lesson suggest asking when a thought grabs you?

- A. Am I the only one who feels this way?
- B. What would my friends think of me?
- C. Is this how the world thinks, or how God thinks?
- D. Can I fix this problem by tomorrow?

5. Romans 12:2 says that a renewed mind helps us discern what?

- A. What other people think of us
- B. The will of God, what is good and acceptable and perfect
- C. How to win every argument
- D. The fastest way to finish our chores

My Notes

Aim Your Thoughts Upward

“Aim at Heaven and you will get earth ‘thrown in’: aim at earth and you will get neither.”

— C. S. Lewis

Colossians 3:2

Set your minds on things that are above, not on things that are on earth.

Paul gives us a direction for our thoughts: up. Setting your mind is like setting a thermostat. You choose the temperature on purpose. You do not have to live at the mercy of every upsetting thought that walks through your mind. You can turn your thoughts toward what is above — toward God, toward His promises, toward what lasts.

Some people hear this and think it means ignoring real life. It does not. C. S. Lewis noticed something interesting: the Christians who did the most good in this world were the ones whose minds were full of the next one. Thinking about heaven does not make you useless on earth. It makes you steady on earth. When your mind is set above, the small things stay small. A rude driver, a messy house, a cranky toddler — they are still real, but they no longer rule you.

Here is what it can look like on a normal morning. Before you pick up your phone, you remind yourself: I belong to God today. He is with me. While you stand at the kitchen sink, instead of

running through everything that could go wrong, you set your mind on one true thing: God has never left me, and He will not start today. At work, when irritation rises, you quietly set your mind above it: I am here to serve, like Jesus served. Nobody around you has to know. It is a quiet choice, made again and again.

Setting your mind is not about feeling spiritual every minute. Feelings come and go. It is about pointing your thoughts in the right direction, the way you point a plant toward the sun. Some days your thoughts will wander back down to earth. That is all right. Just set them upward again. God is patient with this process. Every time you lift your eyes, He is glad.

Prayer

Lord, this morning I choose where my thoughts will live today. Not in the news feed, not in the worry about that bill, not in replaying yesterday's mistakes — but with You, up above. When the kitchen gets loud and the kids need everything at once, lift my eyes. When work feels thankless, remind me I am serving You. You are above it all, and You are with me in it all. Set my mind on You today, and keep setting it back when it wanders. In Jesus' name, amen.

Questions

1. According to Colossians 3:2, where should we set our minds?

- A. On our problems so we can solve them
- B. On what other people are doing
- C. On things that are above, not on things that are on earth
- D. On the past so we learn from it

2. In the lesson, setting your mind is compared to what?

- A. Setting a thermostat to the temperature you choose
- B. Building a house brick by brick
- C. Planting a garden in spring
- D. Filling a jar with stones

3. What did C. S. Lewis observe about Christians whose minds were full of heaven?

- A. They ignored the needs of others
- B. They spent all day in church
- C. They did the most good in this world
- D. They never felt any sadness

4. Which of these is an example from the lesson of setting your mind above?

- A. Checking your phone first thing every morning
- B. Reminding yourself 'God has never left me' while at the kitchen sink
- C. Telling everyone how spiritual you feel
- D. Making sure you never feel sad or tired

5. What does the lesson say to do when your thoughts wander back down to earth?

- A. Feel guilty and give up for the day
- B. Pretend it did not happen
- C. Wait until Sunday to fix it
- D. Simply set your thoughts upward again

My Notes

Drink From the Word Day and Night

“The Bible will keep you from sin, or sin will keep you from the Bible.”

— D. L. Moody

Psalm 1:2-3

but his delight is in the law of the LORD, and on his law he meditates day and night. He is like a tree planted by streams of water that yields its fruit in its season, and its leaf does not wither. In all that he does, he prospers.

The psalm paints a picture of a strong, steady person: a tree planted by streams of water. A tree does not rush. It does not panic in the summer heat because its roots are drinking all the time. That is what God wants for your mind. He wants your thoughts rooted in His Word the way a tree's roots are rooted by the water.

Notice the little word *delight*. This is not about forcing yourself to read the Bible like a chore. It is about finding joy in it. To meditate simply means to turn God's Word over in your mind, the way you turn over a sweet song lyric you cannot forget. You read a verse in the morning, and then at the store later you think about it again. At bedtime it comes back to you. That is meditating day and night. Not reading all day long — just letting one true word stay with you through the day.

D. L. Moody said it plainly: The Bible will keep you from sin, or sin will keep you from the Bible. When your mind is full of God's Word, there is less room for the thoughts that drag you down. The toxic thoughts, the anxious loops, the bitter replays — they lose their grip when your roots are drinking something better.

Start small and simple. Pick one verse — maybe today's — and put it where you will see it: on the fridge, on your bathroom mirror, as your phone's lock screen. Read it out loud once in the morning. Whisper it again while you fold laundry. Let it be the last thing you think about at night instead of the day's worries. You are planting yourself by the stream, one verse at a time. In its season, fruit will come.

Prayer

Lord, tonight I am putting my phone down and picking up Your Word instead. Plant me like that tree by the water. Let Your words sink into my thoughts the way rain sinks into dry ground. Teach me to turn one verse over in my mind while I cook, while I drive, while I lie in bed. Make Your Word my delight, not my duty. Wash the bitter and anxious thoughts out of my mind, and fill those empty spaces with what is true. Thank You that You promise fruit in its season. I trust Your timing. In Jesus' name, amen.

Questions

1. In Psalm 1:2-3, the person who meditates on God's law is compared to what?

- A. A tree planted by streams of water
- B. A bird flying high in the sky

- C. A house built on a hill
- D. A lamp shining in the dark

2. What does the lesson say it means to 'meditate' on God's Word?

- A. Reading the whole Bible in one day
- B. Turning God's Word over in your mind, like a song lyric you cannot forget
- C. Memorizing one hundred verses at once
- D. Thinking about nothing at all

3. What did D. L. Moody say about the Bible and sin?

- A. The Bible is too hard for ordinary people
- B. The Bible will keep you from sin, or sin will keep you from the Bible
- C. Sin and the Bible can live together peacefully
- D. Only pastors need to read the Bible

4. Which small practice does the lesson suggest for meditating day and night?

- A. Pick one verse, put it where you will see it, and think on it through the day
- B. Read for three hours every morning
- C. Only read the Bible at church
- D. Wait until you feel like reading

5. According to Psalm 1:3, what happens to the tree planted by the water?

- A. It yields its fruit in its season, and its leaf does not wither
- B. It never has to grow at all
- C. It moves to a better spot
- D. It grows fruit only in winter

My Notes

Fear Out, Power In

“Worrying is carrying tomorrow's load with today's strength – carrying two days at once. It is moving into tomorrow ahead of time. Worrying does not empty tomorrow of its sorrow; it empties today of its strength.”

— Corrie ten Boom

2 Timothy 1:7

for God gave us a spirit not of fear but of power and love and self-control.

Fear is one of the loudest thoughts a woman can carry. Fear about your children when the text message does not come. Fear about money when the bills stack up. Fear about your health, your aging parents, your future. Fear knocks on the door of your mind every single day. But here is the wonderful news: fear is not from God. It never was. God gave you something else instead — a spirit of power, of love, and of self-control.

Look at those three gifts. Power means you are not helpless; the same God who raised Jesus is at work in you. Love means fear does not get the final word, because perfect love drives fear away. And self-control means you can actually say no to a fearful thought. You do not have to follow every anxious feeling down its dark hallway. You can stop, take a breath, and choose a better thought. That is self-control of the mind, and God Himself put it in you.

Corrie ten Boom knew about fear. She hid Jewish families from the Nazis and was thrown into a concentration camp, where she lost her beloved sister. She said worrying is carrying tomorrow's load with today's strength — carrying two days at once. When you lie awake rehearsing what might happen next week, you are spending strength you were only given for today. God gives you strength one day at a time, like daily bread. Tomorrow's strength will come tomorrow.

Here is a practice for fearful moments. When fear whispers, speak this verse out loud: 'God gave me a spirit not of fear but of power and love and self-control.' Say it in the kitchen. Say it in the car. Say it at your child's bedside. Fear is loud, but God's Word spoken aloud is louder. You are not a fearful woman pretending to be brave. You are a loved daughter of God, and fear simply does not belong to you.

Prayer

Father, tonight my heart is worried about my daughter. She is out in this big world and I cannot protect her every minute, and the what-ifs are circling my mind. Right now I hand her to You — the only One who never sleeps and never leaves. You did not give me a spirit of fear, so I am laying this fear down. Fill me instead with Your power when I feel helpless, Your love when I feel afraid, and Your self-control when my thoughts start to run wild. Give me strength for today only, and let tomorrow rest in Your hands. In Jesus' name, amen.

Questions

1. According to 2 Timothy 1:7, what did God NOT give us?

- A. A spirit of power
- B. A spirit of love
- C. A spirit of self-control
- D. A spirit of fear

2. What does the lesson say 'self-control' means for our minds?

- A. Never feeling any emotion
- B. Being able to say no to a fearful thought and choose a better one
- C. Controlling what other people do
- D. Keeping all our feelings locked inside

3. What did Corrie ten Boom say worrying is like?

- A. Carrying tomorrow's load with today's strength — carrying two days at once
- B. Running a race with no finish line
- C. Planting seeds in rocky soil
- D. Building a house in the rain

4. Which practice does the lesson suggest for fearful moments?

- A. Speaking the verse out loud: 'God gave me a spirit not of fear but of power and love and self-control'
- B. Staying up late to solve every problem
- C. Telling no one and handling it alone
- D. Watching the news to stay informed

5. The lesson says God gives us strength in what way?

- A. All at once for the whole year
- B. Only when we feel strong already
- C. One day at a time, like daily bread
- D. Only after we stop feeling afraid

My Notes

Choose What You Think About

“Faith isn't the ability to believe long and far into the misty future. It's simply taking God at His Word and taking the next step.”

— Joni Eareckson Tada

Philippians 4:8

Finally, brothers, whatever is true, whatever is honorable, whatever is just, whatever is pure, whatever is lovely, whatever is commendable, if there is any excellence, if there is anything worthy of praise, think about these things.

Paul does not leave us guessing about what to think. He hands us a list — a filter for our thoughts. Whatever is true. Whatever is honorable. Whatever is just. Whatever is pure. Whatever is lovely. Whatever is commendable. If there is any excellence, if there is anything worthy of praise — think about these things. Eight simple tests. When a thought comes knocking, you get to hold it up to this list and decide: does this belong in my mind?

(And daughters, when Paul wrote 'brothers,' he meant the whole family of God — every sister included.)

This matters because our minds are fed all day long. The news feed, the gossip at the salon, the show that leaves you uneasy, the group chat that picks someone apart — all of it pours into your thoughts. Paul is saying you do not have to swallow

everything that is served to you. You can choose. You can turn off the noise and turn your mind toward what is true instead.

What is true? That God loves you. That Jesus died for you. That you are forgiven. That He is with you right now. Those are the truest things in the universe, and they are worth more of your thinking time than any headline. Joni Eareckson Tada, who has lived in a wheelchair for decades and still radiates joy, said faith is simply taking God at His Word and taking the next step. You do not have to figure out the whole future. Just take the next true thought, then the next one.

Try this today. When a sour or scary thought arrives, pause and ask: Is this true? Is this lovely? Is this worthy of praise? If not, gently set it down and pick up something that passes the test. Name three true things God has done for you. Say them out loud if you can. This is not pretending problems do not exist. It is choosing to fill your mind with what is real and good while you walk through them.

Prayer

Lord, today at the store I overheard such ugly talk, and then my phone showed me frightening news, and by the time I got home my mind felt dirty and heavy. Wash it clean, Father. Teach me to run every thought through Your filter. Help me ask: is this true, is this lovely, is this worthy of praise? When the answer is no, give me the strength to set that thought down. Remind me of what is true — that You love me, that You forgave me, that You are with me in this very kitchen. One true thought at a time, one next step at a time. That is enough for today. In Jesus' name, amen.

Questions

1. How many qualities does Paul list in Philippians 4:8 as a filter for our thoughts?

- A. Three
- B. Eight
- C. Ten
- D. Twelve

2. Which of these is NOT on Paul's list in Philippians 4:8?

- A. Whatever is true
- B. Whatever is lovely
- C. Whatever is popular
- D. Whatever is pure

3. What does the lesson say about the word 'brothers' in this verse?

- A. It means only men should read this verse
- B. It was a mistake in the Bible
- C. Paul meant the whole family of God — every sister included
- D. It means brothers should teach it to sisters

4. What did Joni Eareckson Tada say faith is?

- A. Understanding everything about the future
- B. Never feeling any pain or sadness
- C. Simply taking God at His Word and taking the next step
- D. Reading the whole Bible every month

5. What practice does the lesson suggest when a sour or scary thought arrives?

- A. Share it with everyone you know
- B. Hold it in and never speak of it

- C. Pause, run it through Paul's filter, and if it fails, set it down and pick up a true thought
- D. Stay up all night analyzing it

Friday Essay

Think of one worry, news story, or conversation that has been weighing on your mind this week. Write a few paragraphs describing it, then run it through Paul's filter in Philippians 4:8. Which of the eight qualities does it fail? What true, lovely, and praiseworthy thoughts could you choose to dwell on instead? Be honest and specific — write as if you are talking to a close friend about what is really going on in your heart.

My Essay

Daily Bread for Your Mind

“I saw more clearly than ever that the first great and primary business to which I ought to attend every day was, to have my soul happy in the Lord.”

— George Müller

Joshua 1:8

This Book of the Law shall not depart from your mouth, but you shall meditate on it day and night, so that you may be careful to do according to all that is written in it. For then you will make your way prosperous, and then you will have good success.

God spoke these words to Joshua when he was about to lead God's people into a brand-new, frightening chapter of life. And what was God's strategy for him? Not a battle plan. Not a pep talk. Just this: keep My Word close — on your lips, in your mind, day and night. God's Word would be his daily strength. The same is true for you. Whatever new or frightening chapter you are facing, His Word is your daily bread.

George Müller understood this. He cared for more than ten thousand orphans in England, and every morning before he did anything else, he fed his own soul on God's Word. He said the first business of every day was to get his soul happy in the Lord. Not to serve first. Not to solve problems first. To be fed first. A mama cannot pour from an empty cup, and neither can a grandmother, a daughter, or a friend. God's Word fills the cup.

Notice where God says the Word should live: it 'shall not depart from your mouth.' That means we speak it. Whisper a verse while you stir the oatmeal. Say it over your grandbaby as you rock her. Pray it back to God in the car. God's Word was never meant to stay trapped on a page. It is meant to be spoken, sung, prayed, and lived — until it becomes the language your mind thinks in.

And look at the promise at the end: then you will make your way prosperous, and then you will have good success. God's idea of success is not fame or money. It is a life that holds steady, a mind at peace, a heart that trusts Him in every season. That kind of success grows slowly, the way a garden grows — one daily watering at a time. Keep showing up to His Word, daughter. He will do the growing.

Prayer

Father, it is early and the house is quiet, and I have my coffee and Your Word open on the kitchen table. Before I feed anyone else today, feed me. Before I solve anyone's problems, let Your words settle into my heart. Make my soul happy in You, the way George Müller prayed. Put Your words on my lips today — while I cook, while I drive, while I tuck little ones into bed. I want Your truth to be the language my mind thinks in. Grow me slowly and steadily, like a garden. Thank You for being my daily bread. In Jesus' name, amen.

Questions

1. What was God's strategy for Joshua as he faced a frightening new chapter?

A. A detailed battle plan

- B. Avoiding all danger
- C. Keeping God's Word close — meditating on it day and night
- D. Waiting for someone else to lead

2. What did George Müller say was the first business of every day?

- A. Serving as many people as possible
- B. Solving the day's problems quickly
- C. Raising money for the orphans
- D. To have his soul happy in the Lord

3. According to Joshua 1:8, where should God's Word live?

- A. Only in a book on a shelf
- B. On our lips — spoken, not just read
- C. Only in church buildings
- D. In our memories of childhood

4. What promise does Joshua 1:8 give to those who meditate on God's Word day and night?

- A. They will make their way prosperous and have good success
- B. They will never face any trouble
- C. They will become famous
- D. They will never need to work again

5. The lesson compares spiritual growth to what?

- A. A race that must be won quickly
- B. A garden that grows with one daily watering at a time
- C. A fire that burns out fast
- D. A mountain that never changes

My Notes

Thank You for a Week of Truth

Daughter, take a quiet moment today and look back at this week. You were intentional. You chose, on purpose, to feed your mind God's truth instead of the world's noise. That is no small thing — that is faithfulness, and your Father sees it.

Thank Him for Monday, when you learned He can transform your thinking from the inside out. Thank Him for Tuesday, when you aimed your thoughts upward. Thank Him for Wednesday, when you drank from His Word like a tree by the stream. Thank Him for Thursday, when you traded fear for His power, love, and self-control. Thank Him for Friday, when you learned to run your thoughts through His filter. Thank Him for Saturday, when His Word became your daily bread.

Being intentional does not mean you were perfect this week. It means you kept turning back to Him. Every time you chose a true thought over a toxic one, heaven noticed. Every whispered verse in the kitchen, every prayer at bedtime, every moment you set your mind above — it all mattered.

So today, rest. Sit with gratitude. Tell the Lord thank you — out loud, in your own words — for the gift of a mind He is renewing. And as a new week begins tomorrow, carry this with you: you do not have to face your thoughts alone. The same God who walked with you this week will walk with you into the next one. Your mind is being renewed, daughter. Keep letting Him do His beautiful work.

My Notes

Looking Back — Week 3

This week we learned that joy grows in a renewed mind — day by day, choice by choice. On Monday, Romans 12:2 showed us that God Himself transforms us by renewing our minds, not by our own straining — and transformation brings joy. On Tuesday, Colossians 3:2 taught us to set our thoughts upward, aiming at heaven the way C. S. Lewis described, and upward thoughts lift a heavy heart. On Wednesday, Psalm 1:2-3 planted us like a tree by the stream, meditating on God’s Word day and night until D. L. Moody’s warning — that the Bible keeps us from sin — became our delight. On Thursday, 2 Timothy 1:7 reminded us that fear was never ours to carry; Corrie ten Boom’s words helped us lay down tomorrow’s load and receive God’s power, love, and self-control instead — and what freedom that is. On Friday, Philippians 4:8 gave us a filter for every thought, and Joni Eareckson Tada showed us that faith is simply taking God at His Word one step at a time. On Saturday, Joshua 1:8 and George Müller’s example made God’s Word our daily bread — spoken, meditated on, and lived. A joyous mind is simply a mind that keeps coming back to truth and finding it sweet. Keep coming back, daughter. He is faithful to finish what He started in you.

My Notes



WEEK 4

Renewed

Welcome to Week 4

Welcome to Week 4, friend — our theme is “Renewed.” This is where it all comes together. For three weeks you have been letting God’s light into your thoughts, trading worry for prayer, and discovering joy in His truth. Now we celebrate the promise underneath it all: God is renewing your mind. Not patching it up, not painting over it — renewing it, making it new from the inside out. Each day this week we will sit with one promise of His finished work: His perfect peace, His gift of peace, His invitation to the weary, His call to be still, His command not to fear, and His shepherd’s care. Come tired, come worried, come just as you are. You are being made new.

Kept in Perfect Peace

“The secret is Christ in me, not me in a different set of circumstances.”

— Elisabeth Elliot

Isaiah 26:3

You keep him in perfect peace whose mind is stayed on you, because he trusts in you.

Maybe you have had a night like this: the house is finally quiet, everyone is in bed, and you pick up your phone just to check one thing. Suddenly it is an hour later, and your mind is full of news, bills, and worries that were never yours to carry. Peace feels far away. God's Word tells us something freeing: peace is not found in having everything fixed. It is found in where your mind rests.

Isaiah 26:3 gives us the promise plainly. God keeps us in perfect peace when our mind is stayed on Him, when we keep turning our thoughts back to Him, because we trust Him. Notice what it does not say. It does not say peace comes when the kids behave, or the money stretches, or the test results come back good. It comes from a mind that keeps choosing God, right in the middle of real life.

Think of your thoughts like a little toddler you have been asked to watch. Left alone, it wanders straight into the street of what if. Your job is not to never have a worried thought. Your job is to gently take that thought by the hand and lead it back to Jesus.

Lord, I trust You with this. Say it out loud in the kitchen. Whisper it at bedtime. Each time you do, you are practicing the promise: a mind stayed on Him, a peace kept by Him.

This week, try one simple habit. Every time a worry starts looping in your mind, pause, name it, and hand it to God in one sentence: Father, I am worried about this, and I trust You. You may need to do it ten times a day. That is all right. Peace grows the way a garden grows, tended daily, not all at once.

Prayer

Father, here I am at the end of the day. My mind wants to replay everything and rehearse tomorrow. Tonight I put my phone down and lift my thoughts up to You instead. Keep me in Your perfect peace. When a worry knocks, help me answer it with trust in You. Thank You that You never sleep, so I can. In Jesus' name, Amen.

Questions

1. According to Isaiah 26:3, who does God keep in perfect peace?

- A. The person who never has a problem
- B. The person whose mind is stayed on God
- C. The person who reads the Bible every single morning
- D. The person who has no worries at all

2. What reason does the verse give for this peace?

- A. Because he trusts in God
- B. Because she works very hard
- C. Because life is easy for him
- D. Because she never makes mistakes

3. In the lesson, worried thoughts are compared to...

- A. A locked door
- B. A heavy backpack
- C. A dark cloud
- D. A wandering toddler

4. What simple habit does the lesson suggest when a worry starts looping?

- A. Ignore the worry completely
- B. Call a friend in the middle of the night
- C. Name the worry and hand it to God in one sentence
- D. Stay busy until you forget about it

5. Elisabeth Elliot's quote says the secret is...

- A. A different set of circumstances
- B. Christ in me
- C. Trying harder every day
- D. Never feeling afraid

My Notes

T U E S D A Y

My Peace I Give You

"In acceptance lieth peace."

— Amy Carmichael

John 14:27

Peace I leave with you; my peace I give to you. Not as the world gives do I give to you. Let not your hearts be troubled, neither let them be afraid.

Jesus spoke these words on the night before He went to the cross. His friends were scared and confused, and He knew it. So He gave them a gift: His own peace. Notice He did not say, I will take away every hard thing. He said, My peace I give to you. Peace is a gift Jesus places in your hands personally. It is not something you have to earn or chase down.

The world's peace depends on everything going right. A quiet house, a healthy family, money in the bank. That is the world's kind of peace, and it breaks the moment one thing changes. Jesus says, Not as the world gives do I give to you. His peace does not depend on your circumstances. It depends on Him. It can sit right beside you in a hospital waiting room, in a hard season of marriage, or on a morning when the news makes your stomach turn.

Amy Carmichael served as a missionary in India for over fifty years, through deep hardship, and she wrote in her poem, "In acceptance lieth peace." Accepting what God has allowed, and

resting in Him, is where true peace is found. The direction of your gaze decides the condition of your heart. When your heart is troubled, the question is not, How do I fix everything? The question is, Where am I looking?

So today, practice turning your eyes. When the headlines, the group chat, or your own thoughts start to trouble your heart, stop and look at Christ instead. Picture Him saying these words to you, the way He said them to His frightened friends: My peace I give to you. Receive it like a gift. You do not have to understand everything to rest in the One who does.

Prayer

Lord Jesus, my heart feels troubled today. The world is loud, and my own thoughts are louder. Thank You that You looked at Your frightened friends and gave them Your peace, and that You give it to me too. I look at You now instead of at my worries. Quiet my heart with Your words: My peace I give to you. Help me carry Your peace into every room I walk into today. Amen.

Questions

1. When did Jesus speak the words of John 14:27?

- A. The night before He went to the cross
- B. After He rose from the dead
- C. When He was twelve years old
- D. On the morning He was born

2. How is Jesus' peace different from the world's peace?

- A. It only works when life is easy
- B. It is only for pastors and missionaries

- C. It lasts longer because it is louder
- D. It does not depend on our circumstances

3. According to the lesson, what decides the condition of your heart?

- A. How much sleep you got last night
- B. The direction of your gaze
- C. What other people think of you
- D. How busy your week is

4. What did Jesus NOT promise in John 14:27?

- A. His peace as a gift
- B. That our hearts need not be troubled
- C. To take away every hard thing
- D. A peace different from the world's

5. Corrie ten Boom learned that looking at Christ brings...

- A. Distress
- B. Rest
- C. Depression
- D. Confusion

My Notes

Come to Me, All Who Are Weary

“Strength of my heart, I rest in Thee, Fulfil Thy purposes through me.”

— Amy Carmichael

Matthew 11:28-30

Come to me, all who labor and are heavy laden, and I will give you rest. Take my yoke upon you, and learn from me, for I am gentle and lowly in heart, and you will find rest for your souls. For my yoke is easy, and my burden is light.

Some days the tiredness is not just in your body. It is in your soul. The lunches are packed, the laundry is folded, the work is done, and yet you sit down and feel like you cannot breathe under the weight of it all. Jesus sees that kind of tired. He does not say, Try harder. He says, Come to Me.

His invitation is for the heavy laden: the woman carrying groceries and grief at the same time, the mother up at night with a sick child and a sick worry, the grandmother holding a family together with prayer and casseroles. I will give you rest, He promises. Rest is not something you earn after the to-do list is finished. It is something He gives when you come.

Then He says something surprising: Take my yoke upon you. A yoke is what joins two oxen together so they can pull as one. Jesus is saying, Do not pull alone anymore. Get in the yoke with Me, and learn from Me. His yoke is easy because He carries the

heavy side. He is gentle and lowly in heart. He will never shame you for being tired, and He will never rush you.

Amy Carmichael, a missionary who served the children of India for more than fifty years, wrote, Strength of my heart, I rest in Thee. She knew that rest is not quitting. Rest is leaning. Today, when the load feels heavy, pause and picture yourself stepping into the yoke beside Jesus. Whisper, I am coming to You, Lord. Then let Him set the pace.

Prayer

Jesus, I am weary and heavy laden, just like You said. I bring You the laundry and the worry, the deadlines and the doctor's appointment, the child I am concerned about and the tiredness I cannot explain. Take my yoke upon me. Walk beside me and teach me Your gentle pace. I rest in You today, and I trust You with what I cannot carry. Amen.

Questions

1. What does Jesus promise to the weary in Matthew 11:28?

- A. More strength to work harder
- B. A shorter to-do list
- C. Rest
- D. Fewer responsibilities

2. In the lesson, a yoke is described as...

- A. What joins two oxen so they can pull together as one
- B. A heavy punishment
- C. A type of morning prayer
- D. A Sabbath rule

3. How does Jesus describe His own heart in verse 29?

- A. Strong and mighty
- B. Busy and hurried
- C. Serious and stern
- D. Gentle and lowly

**4. Amy Carmichael wrote, 'Strength of my heart, I rest in Thee.'
In the lesson, rest is described as...**

- A. Quitting your work
- B. Leaning on Jesus
- C. Sleeping all afternoon
- D. Ignoring your problems

5. According to the lesson, why is Jesus' yoke easy?

- A. Because He removes all our work for us
- B. Because it only applies on Sundays
- C. Because He carries the heavy side with us
- D. Because His standards are lower

My Notes

Be Still

“A willing acceptance of all that God assigns and a glad surrender of all that I am and have constitute the key to receiving the gift of a quiet heart.”

— Elisabeth Elliot

Psalm 46:10

Be still, and know that I am God. I will be exalted among the nations, I will be exalted in the earth!

Be still. Two small words, and maybe the hardest command in the whole Bible for a busy woman. Stillness feels unproductive. There is always one more dish, one more email, one more scroll. But God does not say, Be still when everything is finished. He says, Be still, and know that I am God. Stillness is how we remember who He is, and who we are not.

Notice the order: be still first, and then knowing comes. We often try it backwards. We want to understand everything before we will rest. But God invites us to stop striving first, and let the knowing grow in the quiet. Elisabeth Elliot called it a willing acceptance of all that God assigns and a glad surrender. Surrender sounds like losing, but in God's hands it is how we win our peace back.

Being still does not have to mean an hour of silence you do not have. It can be two minutes on the porch with your morning coffee before the house wakes up. It can be sitting in the parked

car for one breath before you go inside. It can be turning your phone face-down at the dinner table. Small stillnesses, practiced daily, teach your heart that God is God and you do not have to be.

Today, choose one small stillness. Set a timer for three minutes. Sit. Breathe. Say slowly, Be still, and know that I am God. When your mind races to the to-do list, gently bring it back. You are not wasting time. You are doing the most important work of the day: remembering who holds it all.

Prayer

Father, before the noise of the day begins, I sit still with You. You are God, and I am not, and what a relief that is. I surrender the schedule, the worries, the people I love, and the things I cannot fix. Quiet my heart. Teach me to know You in the stillness, not just in the answers. I rest in who You are today. Amen.

Questions

1. According to the lesson, what is the order in Psalm 46:10?

- A. Know first, then be still
- B. Be still first, then knowing comes
- C. Understand everything, then rest
- D. Work hard, then be still

2. What does the lesson say stillness is NOT?

- A. Wasting time
- B. A way to remember who God is
- C. A gift to your heart

D. A daily practice

3. Which small stillness does the lesson suggest?

- A. An hour of silence every morning
- B. Skipping all your chores for a day
- C. Sitting in the parked car for a breath before going inside
- D. Staying up late to worry

4. Elisabeth Elliot's quote says the key to a quiet heart is...

- A. Never feeling any sadness
- B. Keeping a perfect daily schedule
- C. Avoiding every hard thing
- D. A willing acceptance of all God assigns and a glad surrender

5. The lesson's three-minute practice ends with this reminder:

- A. That you must try harder tomorrow
- B. That remembering who holds it all is the most important work of the day
- C. That stillness is only for weekends
- D. That God is too busy to listen

My Notes

Do Not Fear

"Faith does not eliminate questions. But faith knows where to take them."

— Elisabeth Elliot

Isaiah 41:10

fear not, for I am with you; be not dismayed, for I am your God; I will strengthen you, I will help you, I will uphold you with my righteous right hand.

Fear is a thief that visits at the worst times: 2 a.m. when the house is dark, the waiting room when the doctor is late, the moment your grown child does not answer the phone. God knows how fear works, so He does not just say, Calm down. He gives reasons. Fear not, for I am with you. His presence is the answer to our panic.

Then He stacks promise on promise, like blankets on a cold night: I am your God. I will strengthen you. I will help you. I will uphold you. Five I wills from the One who cannot lie. When fear whispers what if, God's Word answers I will. Read those words slowly and let each one land. He is with you. He is your God. He strengthens. He helps. He upholds.

Elisabeth Elliot, who walked through deep loss and hard questions, wrote, "Faith does not eliminate questions. But faith knows where to take them." Fear brings questions — what if, what now, what then? Faith does not pretend the questions are

not there. It takes them to God. Fear borrows trouble from the future and makes you pay interest today. God's way is different: face today with today's strength, and trust Him with tomorrow.

So name your fear out loud to God today. Not the vague I am just anxious, but the real one. The test result. The money. The child. The phone call you are dreading. Then speak Isaiah 41:10 back to it, like a shield: Fear not, for He is with me. Fear shrinks when it is named and answered with a promise. You do not have to feel brave to be held. His righteous right hand is already under you.

Prayer

Father, I am afraid, about the test result, the bill, my child, the call I am dreading. You know exactly which one is mine, and You are not surprised by it. Thank You for Your promises: You are with me, You are my God, You will strengthen me, help me, and uphold me. I hand You tomorrow and take back today. When fear knocks tonight, help me answer with Your Word. Uphold me with Your righteous right hand. In Jesus' name, Amen.

Questions

1. What reason does God give first for 'fear not' in Isaiah 41:10?

- A. For I am with you
- B. For you are strong enough
- C. For tomorrow is certain
- D. For fear is a sin

2. How many 'I will' promises does the lesson count in this verse?

- A. Two
- B. Three
- C. Five
- D. Seven

3. According to Corrie ten Boom's quote, worry...

- A. Solves tomorrow's problems
- B. Empties today of its strength
- C. Is a sign of strong faith
- D. Helps you plan better

4. What does the lesson say fear does?

- A. Protects you from all real harm
- B. Brings you closer to God without trying
- C. Makes tomorrow arrive faster
- D. Borrows trouble from the future and makes you pay interest today

5. What does the lesson suggest doing with a specific fear?

- A. Hide it and hope it goes away
- B. Tell everyone except God
- C. Name it to God and answer it with His promise
- D. Wait until you feel brave

Friday Essay

Think of one specific fear or worry that keeps returning to you, at bedtime, at work, or as you care for your family. Write about how each promise in Isaiah 41:10 speaks to that fear: 'I am with you,' 'I am your God,' 'I will strengthen you,' 'I will help you,' and 'I will uphold you.' Then describe one practical way you will practice resting in His promises this week instead of carrying the worry alone.

My Essay

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal purple lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins or other markings on the paper.

The Lord Is My Shepherd

“Heartache forces us to embrace God out of desperate, urgent need. God is never closer than when your heart is aching.”

— Joni Eareckson Tada

Psalm 23:1-3

The Lord is my shepherd; I shall not want. He makes me lie down in green pastures. He leads me beside still waters. He restores my soul. He leads me in paths of righteousness for his name's sake.

A shepherd's whole job is the sheep. He feeds them, leads them, finds them when they wander, and carries them when they are hurt. David, who had been a shepherd boy himself, looked at his life and said, The Lord is my shepherd. Not was, not might be. Is. Right now. In your kitchen, your car, your hospital room. You are watched over.

Notice what the Shepherd does: He makes us lie down. Sheep only lie down when they feel safe. They will not rest if they are afraid, hungry, or unsettled. Sometimes God has to gently make us lie down, because we will not do it ourselves. The green pastures and still waters are His provision: everything your soul needs, given before you even ask.

He restores my soul. Maybe your soul feels worn thin, from years of giving, from grief, from the daily grind of holding everyone else together. The Shepherd does not scold tired sheep.

He restores them. Joni Eareckson Tada, who has lived for decades in a wheelchair, says, God is never closer than when your heart is aching. Your ache is not a sign He left. It is often where He meets you nearest.

And He leads in paths of righteousness for his name's sake. He guides because that is who He is, not because you have earned it. You do not have to find the path. You just have to follow the Shepherd. Today, rest in this: you are known, you are led, and you shall not want. The Shepherd has you.

Prayer

Lord, my Shepherd, thank You for watching over me this week. Thank You for the green pastures I did not notice and the still waters I walked right past. Restore my soul today, the tired places and the aching places. Lead me in Your paths, not because I have earned it, but because of who You are. I am Yours, and You are mine. I shall not want. Amen.

Questions

1. In the lesson, what is a shepherd's whole job?

- A. The sheep: feeding, leading, finding, and carrying them
- B. Shearing the sheep for wool
- C. Building strong fences
- D. Counting the flock each night

2. According to the lesson, when do sheep lie down?

- A. When it rains
- B. When they feel safe
- C. When the shepherd leaves

D. When they are lost

3. What does 'He restores my soul' mean in the lesson?

- A. God scolds tired sheep
- B. God punishes wandering sheep
- C. God ignores our pain
- D. God renews the worn and weary places in us

4. Joni Eareckson Tada says God is never closer than...

- A. When everything is going perfectly
- B. When you are very busy
- C. When your heart is aching
- D. When you feel strong and independent

5. Why does the Shepherd lead us in right paths, according to verse 3?

- A. For his name's sake
- B. Because we earned it
- C. Because we asked perfectly
- D. Because we never wander

My Notes

A Grateful Heart That Rests

Sunday is for looking back with thanks. This week, you were intentional about resting in God's peace, not just reading about it, but practicing it. Maybe you put the phone down at bedtime and handed your worries to God. Maybe you whispered 'My peace I give to you' in a hard moment. Maybe you sat still for three minutes, or named a fear out loud, or pictured the Shepherd walking beside you. None of that was small. Every time you turned your mind to Him, you were building a quieter heart. Thank Him today: for the peace He kept, the rest He gave, and the promises He will keep carrying into next week. Rest is not a place you arrive. Rest is a Person you return to, again and again.

My Notes

Looking Back — Week 4

This week we celebrated the renewed mind God is building in us — not the absence of trouble but the presence of a whole new way of thinking. On Monday, Isaiah 26:3 showed us that perfect peace belongs to the mind stayed on Him. On Tuesday, Jesus gave us His own peace in John 14:27, a peace the world cannot give and cannot take away. On Wednesday, His invitation in Matthew 11:28-30 welcomed every weary heart to lay its burden down and walk in His easy yoke. On Thursday, Psalm 46:10 taught us the holy habit of being still and knowing He is God. On Friday, Isaiah 41:10 answered every fear with five promises: He is with us, He is our God, He strengthens, He helps, He upholds. And on Saturday, Psalm 23 reminded us that the Lord Himself is our Shepherd: He makes us lie down, leads us beside still waters, and restores our souls. Renewed is not just what your mind is becoming — it is who you are becoming in Him. Keep walking in it, daughter. The work He began, He will finish.

My Notes

Answer Key

WEEK 1 · ENLIGHTENED

Monday – Naming the Thoughts: 1-C 2-A 3-B 4-D 5-C

Tuesday – Guard What Goes In: 1-D 2-A 3-C 4-B 5-A

Wednesday – The Lies We Believe About Ourselves: 1-C 2-D 3-B 4-A 5-D

Thursday – Worry vs. Trust: 1-B 2-D 3-A 4-C 5-A

Friday – Setting Your Mind on the Spirit: 1-A 2-C 3-B 4-D 5-A

Saturday – Speaking Truth Out Loud: 1-D 2-C 3-A 4-B 5-C

WEEK 2 · PEACEFUL

Monday – Bring It All to Him: 1-C 2-A 3-D 4-B 5-C

Tuesday – A Peace That Stands Guard: 1-B 2-D 3-A 4-C 5-B

Wednesday – Let Him Carry It: 1-D 2-B 3-C 4-A 5-D

Thursday – Your Father Already Knows: 1-A 2-C 3-B 4-D 5-C

Friday – Thanksgiving Fights Worry: 1-C 2-D 3-A 4-B 5-D

Saturday – Cheered by His Comfort: 1-B 2-A 3-D 4-C 5-A

WEEK 3 · JOYOUS

Monday – Let God Change the Way You Think: 1-B 2-D 3-A 4-C 5-B

Tuesday – Aim Your Thoughts Upward: 1-C 2-A 3-D 4-B 5-D

Wednesday – Drink From the Word Day and Night: 1-A 2-C 3-B 4-D 5-A

Thursday – Fear Out, Power In: 1-D 2-B 3-C 4-A 5-C

Friday – Choose What You Think About: 1-B 2-A 3-D 4-C 5-B

Saturday – Daily Bread for Your Mind: 1-C 2-D 3-B 4-A 5-D

WEEK 4 · RENEWED

Monday – Kept in Perfect Peace: 1-B 2-A 3-D 4-C 5-B

Tuesday – My Peace I Give You: 1-A 2-D 3-B 4-C 5-B

Wednesday – Come to Me, All Who Are Weary: 1-C 2-A 3-D 4-B 5-C

Thursday – Be Still: 1-B 2-A 3-C 4-D 5-B

Friday – Do Not Fear: 1-A 2-C 3-B 4-D 5-C

Saturday – The Lord Is My Shepherd: 1-A 2-B 3-D 4-C 5-A